



Left to Right: Ms Aenna Jagga, Head Business Development, APSEZ; Mr Ketan Gajjar, CEO, MERC; Mr Ashwini Gupta, Wholetime Director and CEO, APSEZ; Mr Richard Janssen, CEO, SMIT; Mr Shyam Jagannathan, Director General of Shipping and Mr Sushil Mansing Khopde, Additional Director General of Shipping.

SAFE HARBOUR FOR UNCERTAIN SEAS: APSEZ'S PORT OF REFUGE

As shipping risks rise, the Adani Group's initiative aligns India with international maritime safety standards while strengthening its position across key trade corridors.



At Dighi on India's west coast, APSEZ's Port of Refuge enhances preparedness for maritime emergencies.

India's vast coastline and strategic location along some of the world's busiest shipping routes have long made maritime safety a critical concern. Yet, until recently, a key piece of emergency infrastructure remained missing. That gap is now being addressed.

Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Ltd (APSEZ), India's largest integrated transport utility, which handles around 27 per cent of the country's port cargo volumes, has operationalised the country's first Port of Refuge (PoR), creating a formal mechanism to manage vessels in distress and maritime emergencies. At a time when global shipping is navigating heightened geopolitical tensions, including the ongoing conflict in West Asia that has disrupted key maritime routes and increased risks for commercial vessels, the need for structured emergency response systems has become more urgent than ever. A PoR, as defined by the International Maritime Organization (IMO), is a designated location where a ship in distress can seek shelter to stabilise its condition, safeguard human life and minimise environmental damage. While such frameworks are standard across advanced maritime economies, India had not formalised one until now.

Closing a Critical Gap in Maritime Safety

The introduction of a formal PoR framework marks a significant step in strengthening India's maritime preparedness. With over